



BRITANNIA SECONDARY SCHOOL

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I was asked by Stephanie Slen to provide a letter of reference and I am pleased to comply. I have known Stephanie for five years and know her to be an incredible young woman.

I have known Stephanie for five years and in that time, I have been constantly impressed by her commitment to Britannia Secondary, her community, her peers, and the world around her. She is, indeed, a special person and one that has had a profound impact on me.

Stephanie is the epicenter of our school. Every good thing that occurs is either touched, produced, guided, sponsored, or completed by Stephanie. This is not an exaggeration. She is front and centre every single day. She is hard-wired to do this. She is not doing this to pad an already ridiculous resume. She operates selflessly, with a relentless desire to make this world better. She is one of those rare people who always have their head up – excited about what she might see – excited about what she could experience. That willingness to engage has impressed me so much.

She is a tremendous leader. Where others might allow others to produce the change that either a school, a team, or student council, needs, Stephanie steps up. She accepts that responsibility head on and is willing to put in the time and work needed to produce excellent results. Those results provide appreciable benefits for hundreds of students, athletes, and peers.

As the coach of the Britannia Cross Country team, I first met Stephanie in Grade 8. What I admired about Stephanie then and still do to this day is her willingness to invest in herself and the team around her. Stephanie always shows up to practice, ready to work, ready to get better. She always leads by example. Regardless of the weather outside, I know I can count on Stephanie to be on the track, showing the next crop of athletes what it takes to get to the next level. She has devoted a significant portion of her free time to become the best runner she can. She has run 8 half marathons in the past 3 years. More importantly, to me, is that over that same time she has brought out dozens of new athletes to our team. Stephanie is the student I reach out to if I need help. If an athlete is struggling and needs assistance, Stephanie is the person I will ask to intervene. If we are having an overnight trip and a nervous student needs a nice, supportive roommate, Stephanie will be that roommate. She is an incredible young woman who has big dreams. I know she'll get there. She's proven her mettle. On top of her willingness to support, promote and participate in our school, Stephanie has been a top student every year. She manages her commitments with precision and intent – always making the right decision. She has performed at the highest level academically for the past 5 years, while volunteering hundreds of hours to a variety of causes.

Stephanie comes from a modest home. They live in subsidized housing and struggle to make ends meet. Stephanie has always done her part to help support her family and on top of that she has worked tirelessly to support other vulnerable students in our community. She has led countless initiatives at Britannia to provide equity and access for all students, regardless of their economic situation.

I will not reprint her resume here. She is far too talented, far too committed and far too extraordinary to do that. She is amazing. She means so much to our school and by extension, myself, as someone who, like Stephanie, tries to make the world around her as great as it can be. She has done exactly that. Our school is irrevocably better because she came here in grade 8. I will miss her dearly but will take solace knowing what a privilege it was to be present while she attended Britannia.

If you have any questions about my letter, please feel free to contact me at your convenience.

Sincerely,

Trevor Stokes

Department Head – Alternative Programs, Britannia Secondary